

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 23

Group 23 Vocabulary

1. Allusive

Meaning: Referring indirectly to something.

Tip to remember: Allusive comes from allusion, which means an indirect reference. If a writer hints at another story, the writing is allusive.

Sentence: The poem was allusive and referred indirectly to ancient myths.

2. Astute

Meaning: Clever, sharp, and good at understanding situations quickly.

Tip to remember: Astute sounds like “a student” who is very sharp and observant.

Sentence: The astute investor noticed the risk before others did.

3. Commence

Meaning: To begin or start.

Tip to remember: Commence sounds formal, like a ceremony beginning. Commencement means a beginning.

Sentence: The exam will commence at exactly nine o'clock.

4. Convalescent

Meaning: Recovering from illness or weakness.

Tip to remember: Think of a patient slowly gaining strength after sickness. That person is convalescent.

Sentence: The convalescent patient needed rest and healthy food.

5. Curb

Meaning: To control, limit, or restrain something.

Tip to remember: A road curb keeps vehicles from going beyond the edge. To curb something is to keep it under control.

Sentence: The government introduced rules to curb pollution.

6. Decry

Meaning: To publicly criticize or condemn.

Tip to remember: Decry sounds like “cry against.” If you decry something, you speak strongly against it.

Sentence: The activists decried the destruction of the forest.

7. **Duress**
Meaning: Force, pressure, or threats used to make someone do something.
Tip to remember: Duress sounds like “distress.” If you act under duress, you act under distressing pressure.
Sentence: The confession was rejected because it was made under duress.
8. **Evoke**
Meaning: To bring a feeling, memory, or image into the mind.
Tip to remember: Evoke sounds like “invoke.” It calls up memories or emotions.
Sentence: The old song evoked memories of his childhood.
9. **Fawn**
Meaning: To praise or flatter someone too much in order to gain favor.
Tip to remember: Think of a small fawn acting helpless and sweet to get attention. To fawn is to flatter excessively.
Sentence: The employee fawned over the boss to get a promotion.
10. **Fret**
Meaning: To worry or be anxious.
Tip to remember: Fret sounds like “fear it.” If you fret, you keep worrying about it.
Sentence: Do not fret too much about one practice test score.
11. **Glib**
Meaning: Smooth and fluent but insincere or shallow.
Tip to remember: Think of someone speaking smoothly like oil, but without honesty or depth. That is glib.
Sentence: His glib answer failed to convince the interviewers.
12. **Headstrong**
Meaning: Stubborn and determined to do what one wants.
Tip to remember: Think of someone whose head is too strong to bend toward advice.
Sentence: The headstrong student refused to change his flawed method.
13. **Intermittent**
Meaning: Starting and stopping at irregular intervals.
Tip to remember: Think of electricity that comes and goes. Intermittent means not continuous.
Sentence: The village faced intermittent power cuts during the storm.
14. **Ire**
Meaning: Anger or wrath.
Tip to remember: Ire sounds like “fire.” Anger can burn like fire.
Sentence: The unfair decision drew the ire of the students.
15. **Languid**
Meaning: Slow, weak, tired, or lacking energy.

Tip to remember: Languid sounds like “low energy.” A languid person moves slowly and lazily.

Sentence: The hot afternoon made everyone feel languid.

16. **Lull**

Meaning: A temporary calm or pause; to make someone calm or sleepy.

Tip to remember: Think of a lullaby that makes a child calm and sleepy.

Sentence: There was a brief lull in the storm before the rain returned.

17. **Mettlesome**

Meaning: Brave, energetic, and spirited.

Tip to remember: Mettle means courage. A mettlesome person has strong inner courage.

Sentence: The mettlesome athlete continued despite the injury.

18. **Mollify**

Meaning: To calm someone down or make anger less intense.

Tip to remember: Mollify sounds like “make mellow.” To mollify someone is to make them calmer.

Sentence: The manager tried to mollify the angry customer with an apology.

19. **Neutralize**

Meaning: To cancel, counteract, or make ineffective.

Tip to remember: In chemistry, an acid and base neutralize each other. In GRE, neutralize means cancel the effect.

Sentence: The new evidence neutralized the opponent’s argument.

20. **Nonplussed**

Meaning: Confused and unsure how to respond.

Tip to remember: Think of your brain saying “no plus,” meaning it cannot add anything because it is confused.

Sentence: The unexpected question left the speaker nonplussed.

21. **Precipitous**

Meaning: Very steep; sudden and dramatic.

Tip to remember: Think of a steep cliff where things drop suddenly. A precipitous decline is a sudden drop.

Sentence: The company experienced a precipitous fall in sales.

22. **Pretentious**

Meaning: Trying to appear more important, intelligent, or cultured than one really is.

Tip to remember: Pretentious comes from pretend. A pretentious person pretends to be impressive.

Sentence: His pretentious speech used difficult words without real meaning.

23. **Profound**

Meaning: Very deep, serious, or meaningful.

Tip to remember: Think of a deep ocean. A profound idea has deep meaning.
Sentence: The book had a profound effect on her thinking.

24. **Propagate**

Meaning: To spread, promote, or reproduce.

Tip to remember: Think of plants propagating by producing more plants. Ideas can also propagate through society.

Sentence: Social media can propagate false information quickly.

25. **Recourse**

Meaning: A source of help or option used in a difficult situation.

Tip to remember: Think of returning to a course of action when you have no other choice. That option is recourse.

Sentence: When negotiation failed, they had recourse to legal action.

26. **Refute**

Meaning: To prove that something is wrong or false.

Tip to remember: Refute sounds like “re-fight.” You fight against an argument with evidence.

Sentence: The scientist refuted the claim with experimental data.

27. **Regress**

Meaning: To move backward or return to a worse or earlier condition.

Tip to remember: Progress means move forward; regress means move backward.

Sentence: Without practice, his speaking skills began to regress.

28. **Repercussion**

Meaning: A consequence or indirect effect of an action, usually negative.

Tip to remember: Think of a sound echoing after a drumbeat. A repercussion is the echo of an action.

Sentence: The decision had serious repercussions for the whole company.

29. **Replenish**

Meaning: To fill again or restore a supply.

Tip to remember: Re means again, and replenish means fill. Replenish means fill again.

Sentence: The rain helped replenish the village’s water supply.

30. **Vigilant**

Meaning: Watchful, alert, and careful to notice danger.

Tip to remember: Think of a security guard watching carefully at night. That guard is vigilant.

Sentence: A vigilant engineer can detect faults before they become serious.